WSQ Course Code: TGS-2024043856

Enhance Work Productivity with Microsoft 365 Copilot

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Digital Attendance (Mandatory)

1

TRAQOM survey

Complete the SSG Training Quality and Outcome Measurement survey when instructed.

2

Assessment

Complete the separate assessment attendance before the papers.

3

Scan

Use the QR code shown by the trainer or administrator.

4

Eligibility

Maintain at least 75% attendance and achieve a Competent outcome.

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COURSE ADMINISTRATION

Welcome & Housekeeping

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About the Trainer



Your Trainer

Complete before class

NAME

TITLE / DESIGNATION

QUALIFICATIONS

EXPERTISE

EXPERIENCE

CONTACT

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NAMED TRAINER

About the Trainer



Dr Alfred Ang

Principal Trainer · Tertiary Infotech Academy

ROLE
Principal Trainer and Chief Instructional Designer

EXPERTISE
Microsoft 365, AI, automation and business productivity

CERTIFICATION
ACLP-certified adult educator

DELIVERS
WSQ and professional technology programmes

EXPERIENCE
Cross-industry transformation and workforce training

CONTACT
enquiry@tertiaryinfotech.com

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ICE-BREAKER

Let's Know Each Other

1. Your name, role and one HR service reporting task.
2. Which app holds the HR-case source?
3. Which date and status definitions determine overdue work?
4. Check which Copilot buttons and skills menus are available in your assigned apps.

HOUSEKEEPING

Ground Rules

1. Set your mobile phone to silent mode.
2. Participate actively — no question is too small.
3. Mutual respect: agree to disagree.
4. One conversation at a time.
5. Be punctual; return from breaks on time.
6. Learn by doing — try every hands-on lab.

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Your Course Materials

1. Trainer slides explain concepts and evidence boundaries
2. Learner Guide contains detailed procedures and troubleshooting
3. 14 lab folders provide prompts, synthetic data and checkpoints
4. Prompt page supports clean copy and paste by app
5. Keep outputs in one dated Lumina working folder

Course page: https://www.tertiarycourses.com.sg/wsq-enhance-work-productivity-with-microsoft-365-copilot.html

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SCHEDULE

Lesson Plan — 2 Days, 14 instructional hours

Course sequence

- Day 1 — Copilot fundamentals, reusable Skills and controlled transition
  - Topic 1: Microsoft 365 Copilot Fundamentals (Labs 1–2)
  - Topic 2: Skills, Rules and Personalisation (Labs 3–6)

Day 2

- Day 2 — Interactive dashboard, professional presentation and Microsoft 365 business agents
  - Topic 3: Create Interactive Dashboard and Professional Presentation (Labs 7–10)
  - Topic 4: Create Microsoft 365 Agents for Businesses (Labs 11–14)
- Daily timing
  - 9:00 am - 6:30 pm (1-hour lunch; two 15-minute breaks excluded; 7 instructional hours plus 1 assessment hour)

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WHAT YOU'LL ACHIEVE

Learning Outcomes

1

Integration risks

Predict and mitigate challenges in integrating Microsoft Copilot to workflow.

2

Transition plan

Develop a plan for implementing Microsoft Copilot to ensure seamless transition from legacy workflow.

3

Teams and Outlook opportunities

Evaluate opportunities in using Microsoft Copilot for Teams and Outlook.

4

Staff training plan

Design a training plan for staff to use Microsoft Loop and Copilot Studio.

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Learning and Assessment Route

1. Trainer demonstrates the technical mechanism
2. You build and verify it in a connected lab
3. WA-SAQ: 60 minutes · K1-K4
4. PP: 60 minutes · A1-A4
5. Competent outcome + minimum 75% attendance

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Skills Framework Alignment

1

K1

Relevant systems and software

2

K2

Organisation's processes

3

K3

Systems transition process

4

K4

Emerging technological trends such as machine learning, artificial intelligence and robotic process automation

5

A1–A4

Transition risks, controlled implementation, opportunity evaluation and staff enablement are practised across 14 labs.

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TOPIC 1

Microsoft 365 Copilot Fundamentals

Grounding, HR-case grain, prompts and verified handoffs

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Key Concepts — Microsoft 365 Copilot Fundamentals

1

Grounding

Select actual sources in every app.

2

HR cases

Keep IDs, dates, status and current ownership stable.

3

Prompt contract

Goal, context, source and expected output.

4

Transition risk

Verify licences, permissions, data quality and claims.

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WHAT YOU'LL DO

Hands-On Labs — Microsoft 365 Copilot Fundamentals

Lab 1

- **Excel to Word**
  - Prepare HR Cases and Draft the HR Service Brief

Lab 2

- **Word to PowerPoint and Outlook**
  - Create the Cross-App HR Service Update

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CONNECTED USE CASE

The Lumina HR Service Evidence Chain

1. Excel: clean and check
2. Word: HR service brief
3. PowerPoint: decision story
4. Outlook: reviewed draft

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EDITABLE DATA MODEL

A HR Case Has State, Scope and Ownership

ID
HR-2026-0003

Department
Retail Sales

Category
Leave Request

Status
In Progress

Owner
Chloe Goh

Current owner is evidence. Proposed owner is a separate planning output.

Source: synthetic tblHRCases | 30 Sep 2026 | All filters All unless stated

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Grounding Across Microsoft 365

WHAT IT IS

- Grounding gives an AI request the specific evidence it should use.

WHY IT MATTERS

- An HR service figure can be correct in Excel yet become wrong in an email when the source, reporting date or filter scope changes.

CHECK IT

- Excel analyses tblHRCases; Word receives the checked summary.

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Grounding Across Microsoft 365

1. Identify the authoritative HR-case table.
2. Provide goal, context, source and expected output.
3. Review against the named evidence.
4. Pass a verified snapshot to the next app.

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Apply the Concept — Grounding Across Microsoft 365

PROMPT PRINCIPLES

- Name the source, reporting date and selected scope.
- Explain the result using checked evidence.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- PowerPoint receives the reviewed Word brief; Outlook receives the same checked values.
- An Excel chat transcript is not an automatic PowerPoint data source.

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Evidence Trace — Grounding Across Microsoft 365

1

Source

https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/file-formats-supported-by-microsoft-365-copilot

2

State

Excel analyses tblHRCases; Word receives the checked summary.

3

Check

PowerPoint receives the reviewed Word brief; Outlook receives the same checked values.

4

Boundary

The prompt assumes access to another app chat or local path.

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HR-Case Grain and Reporting Measures

WHAT IT IS

- A row represents one HR case, identified by Case_ID.

WHY IT MATTERS

- An exact duplicated export row changes counts and cost without representing new work.

CHECK IT

- 122 raw rows contain 120 distinct HR-case IDs.

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HR-Case Grain and Reporting Measures

1. Define one ID per HR case.
2. Find exact repeated export records.
3. Standardise labels without inventing facts.
4. Reconcile cleaned counts and cost.

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Apply the Concept — HR-Case Grain and Reporting Measures

PROMPT PRINCIPLES

- Name the source, reporting date and selected scope.
- Explain the result using checked evidence.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- Total = Closed + Cancelled + Backlog after exact duplicate removal.
- Due on 30 September is not overdue at the 30 September snapshot.

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Evidence Trace — HR-Case Grain and Reporting Measures

1

Source

https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/excel/create-and-share-a-dashboard-with-excel-and-microsoft-groups

2

State

122 raw rows contain 120 distinct HR-case IDs.

3

Check

Total = Closed + Cancelled + Backlog after exact duplicate removal.

4

Boundary

Duplicate IDs contain conflicting records or reporting scope is unknown.

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LAB 1 THEME · EXCEL TO WORD

Prepare HR Cases and Draft the HR Service Brief

LAB 1

You are Lumina Living's HR operations executive. A Q3 export contains repeated IDs and inconsistent category labels.

You'll build

Lumina_Clean_HR_Cases.xlsx and Lumina_HR_Service_Brief.docx, with reconciled counts, reporting scope and a source register.

1 Ground	2 Build	3 Verify	4 Handoff

Tools: Microsoft 365 Copilot · Excel · Word · PowerPoint · Outlook · OneDrive

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Sample Prompts — Lab 1

1. Inspect: Using Lumina_HR_Cases.xlsx, confirm 120 unique Case_ID values, preserve Current_Assignee, and report data-quality exceptions at 30 September 2026.

2. Brief: Draft the Lumina HR Service Brief from the verified 120-row snapshot; cite backlog 60 and overdue 50 and label missing causes UNKNOWN.

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Check Your Results — Lab 1

1

Clean table

120 unique Case_ID rows; five canonical request types.

2

Portfolio identity

120 = 48 Closed + 12 Cancelled + 60 backlog.

3

Evidence handoff

Overdue 50; unassigned backlog 6; total cost S$35,827.50. Word agrees with Excel.

4

No guessed owner

Blank assignments remain blank; proposals labelled unapproved.

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Prompts and Verified App Handoffs

WHAT IT IS

- A useful prompt combines the intended goal, operational context, named source and output expectations.

WHY IT MATTERS

- The same number may have different meaning when a chart counts all HR cases while an email calls it open backlog.

CHECK IT

- Goal: draft an HR service update for the HR manager.

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Prompts and Verified App Handoffs

1. Write the goal and audience.
2. Attach or select the actual source.
3. Specify definitions and missing-value behaviour.
4. Reconcile the returned claims.

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Apply the Concept — Prompts and Verified App Handoffs

PROMPT PRINCIPLES

- Name the source, reporting date and selected scope.
- Explain the result using checked evidence.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- Source: reviewed Lumina HR service brief, all filters All, 30 September.
- Expectation: label assignment suggestions as proposals and leave unknown approvals UNKNOWN.

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Evidence Trace — Prompts and Verified App Handoffs

1

Source

https://support.microsoft.com/en-gb/word/copilot/draft-and-add-content-with-copilot-in-word

2

State

Goal: draft an HR service update for the HR manager.

3

Check

Source: reviewed Lumina HR service brief, all filters All, 30 September.

4

Boundary

Only an unverified summary is available.

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Outlook Drafting and Operational Decisions

WHAT IT IS

- Copilot can help structure a draft email from supplied context.

WHY IT MATTERS

- An apparently routine update can accidentally promise HR officer reassignment or imply that a manager approved a recovery plan.

CHECK IT

- Current owner blank; proposed owner Aisha remains unapproved.

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Outlook Drafting and Operational Decisions

1. Provide the synthetic thread and checked facts.
2. Draft a concise update.
3. Review recipients, facts and action wording.
4. Save the unsent draft and evidence.

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Apply the Concept — Outlook Drafting and Operational Decisions

PROMPT PRINCIPLES

- Name the source, reporting date and selected scope.
- Explain the result using checked evidence.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- A draft addressed to example.invalid is a training artifact.
- The handoff says decision requested, not decision approved.

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Evidence Trace — Outlook Drafting and Operational Decisions

1

Source

https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/file-formats-supported-by-microsoft-365-copilot

2

State

Current owner blank; proposed owner Aisha remains unapproved.

3

Check

A draft addressed to example.invalid is a training artifact.

4

Boundary

The task would imply a real approval or send without review.

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Create the Cross-App HR Service Update

LAB 2

Continue the verified HR service brief from Lab 1. You will turn it into an initial PowerPoint update, then prepare an Outlook reply to a synthetic HR service thread.

You'll build

Lumina_Initial_Update.pptx, an unsent Outlook draft and Lumina_Cross_App_Evidence.csv with Excel, Word, PowerPoint and Outlook figures reconciled.

1 Ground	2 Build	3 Verify	4 Handoff

Tools: Microsoft 365 Copilot · Excel · Word · PowerPoint · Outlook · OneDrive

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Sample Prompts — Lab 2

1. Handoff: Using the verified Lumina HR Service Brief, create a five-slide HR service update and an unsent Outlook draft with the same 30 September 2026 scope.

2. Verify: Reconcile every count, date and current assignment in the deck and email against Lumina_HR_Cases.xlsx.

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Check Your Results — Lab 2

1

Four apps

Excel Checks, Word brief, four-slide update and unsent Outlook draft share the same date and values.

2

Cross-app grounding

Named file or pasted verified evidence is provided in each app; no assumed shared chat.

3

Draft boundary

example.invalid recipient; nothing sent and no assignment approved.

4

LO1 checkpoint

Integration Risk Register has all three rows, fixed date/baseline evidence and no invented cause or approval.

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TOPIC RECAP

Recap - Microsoft 365 Copilot Fundamentals

1. LO1: Integration risks and verified cross-app handoffs documented.

2. Verify: 120 unique IDs; facts and proposals separate.

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TOPIC 2

Skills, Rules and Personalisation

Account preferences, workbook conventions and reusable methods

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Key Concepts — Skills, Rules and Personalisation

1

Personalisation

Account preferences across workbooks.

2

.Rules

Visible instructions travel with the workbook.

3

Skills

Reusable Pareto, reporting and dashboard methods.

4

Transition plan

Protect source, test reruns and preserve rollback.

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WHAT YOU'LL DO

Hands-On Labs — Skills, Rules and Personalisation

Labs 3–4

- **Personalisation**
  - Personalise Copilot in Excel for Consistent HR Service Reports
- **Workbook .Rules**
  - Create and Test Workbook .Rules for HR Service Reporting

Labs 5–6

- **Custom Pareto Chart Skill**
  - Create a Custom Pareto Chart Skill and Apply It
- **Reporting Skill**
  - Create, Use and Improve the HR Service Reporting Skill

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EDITABLE SCOPE COMPARISON

Four Scopes of Customisation

1

Personalisation: your account

2

.Rules: this workbook

3

Skill: repeated method

4

Prompt: this request

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Account Personalisation and Specific Requests

WHAT IT IS

- Excel Copilot Personalisation stores account-level preferences for display, writing style and formula conventions.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Consistent S$ display and short explanations reduce repetitive requests without changing numeric values.

CHECK IT

- A value of 35827.5 can display as S$35,827.50 or S$35,827.5000.

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Account Personalisation and Specific Requests

1. Choose recurring display preferences.
2. Save them to the account.
3. Compare two workbook outputs.
4. Test a specific request and restore.

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Apply the Concept — Account Personalisation and Specific Requests

PROMPT PRINCIPLES

- Name the source, reporting date and selected scope.
- Explain the result using checked evidence.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- Changing a number format does not change its numeric value.
- Another user opening the file does not receive your account preferences.

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Evidence Trace — Account Personalisation and Specific Requests

1

Source

https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/excel/copilot/copilot-in-excel-personalization

2

State

A value of 35827.5 can display as S$35,827.50 or S$35,827.5000.

3

Check

Changing a number format does not change its numeric value.

4

Boundary

The instruction is a workbook-specific business rule or source change.

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LAB 3 THEME · PERSONALISATION

Personalise Copilot in Excel for Consistent HR Service Reports

LAB 3

Configure temporary account-level display and explanation preferences, test them in two copies of the same verified Lumina workbook, and distinguish preferences from workbook-specific definitions. A task-specific prompt can supersede Personalisation.

You'll build

Lumina_Personalisation_Test.xlsx, a two-workbook preference comparison and a private note confirming settings restored.

1 Ground	2 Build	3 Verify	4 Handoff

Tools: Microsoft 365 Copilot in Excel · OneDrive

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Sample Prompts — Lab 3

1. Personalise: For Lumina HR service reports, prefer concise headings, SGD currency, DD MMM YYYY dates and a Sources and Limitations section.

2. Test: Summarise Lumina backlog 60 and overdue 50 with and without the saved preference; record the observed difference.

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Check Your Results — Lab 3

1

Source controls

Both copies retain120 unique IDs, original owners/statuses and exact cost 35827.50.

2

Display check

Saved S$ two-decimal/date/explanation preferences are checked in two workbooks; observed misses are recorded.

3

Specific request

The output can show35,827.5000 without changing its value or the saved preferences.

4

Restoration

Previous account preferences restored; private baseline note stays outside public courseware.

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EDITABLE WORKBOOK MODEL

Visible .Rules: Instructions Travel with the Workbook

A1	Lumina reporting conventions
A2	Preserve original IDs and current owners
A3	Backlog excludes Closed and Cancelled
A4	Reporting date: 2026-09-30

Formula rule reads Control!B2; Copilot uses the recalculated result on the next request.

Source: synthetic tblHRCases | 30 Sep 2026 | All filters All unless stated

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Visible Workbook .Rules and Formula Results

WHAT IT IS

- A visible worksheet named exactly .Rules, including the dot, supplies workbook-specific Copilot instructions in column A.

WHY IT MATTERS

- The workbook can carry stable scope, status, cost-display and preservation instructions alongside the source.

CHECK IT

- The date rule returns Reporting date: 2026-09-30 from Control!B2.

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Visible Workbook .Rules and Formula Results

1. Name the visible sheet exactly .Rules.
2. Place one instruction per column-A cell.
3. Recalculate a formula-driven rule.
4. Check the next output and copied workbook.

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Apply the Concept — Visible Workbook .Rules and Formula Results

PROMPT PRINCIPLES

- Name the source, reporting date and selected scope.
- Explain the result using checked evidence.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- Hidden .Rules is not used; keep the final sheet visible.
- No universal precedence among rules, preferences and Skills is assumed.

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Evidence Trace — Visible Workbook .Rules and Formula Results

1

Source

https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/excel/copilot/copilot-in-excel-rules

2

State

The date rule returns Reporting date: 2026-09-30 from Control!B2.

3

Check

Hidden .Rules is not used; keep the final sheet visible.

4

Boundary

You need a security boundary or are assuming hidden rules apply.

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Create and Test Workbook .Rules for HR Service Reporting

LAB 4

Turn Lumina's workbook conventions into a visible .Rules worksheet. Keep one rule per cell in column A, include a formula-driven reporting-date rule, test the output, and verify that the sheet travels with a copied workbook.

You'll build

Lumina_Rules_Workbook.xlsx with visible .Rules column A, a checked Rules_Test output and a copied-workbook sharing check.

1 Ground	2 Build	3 Verify	4 Handoff

Tools: Microsoft 365 Copilot in Excel · OneDrive

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Sample Prompts — Lab 4

1. .Rules: In the visible .Rules sheet, require 30 September 2026, UNKNOWN for missing evidence, and separate Current_Assignee from Proposed_Assignee.

2. Boundary: Test one request that lacks a reporting date and verify that Copilot asks for it instead of guessing.

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Check Your Results — Lab 4

1

Recognition

Exactly .Rules; visible worksheet; instructions in column A, one idea per cell.

2

Formula rule

Reporting-date formula recalculates and displays2026-09-30; no source values changed.

3

Output controls

120 total;60 backlog;50 overdue;30/48 on-time;S$35,827.50 at All scope.

4

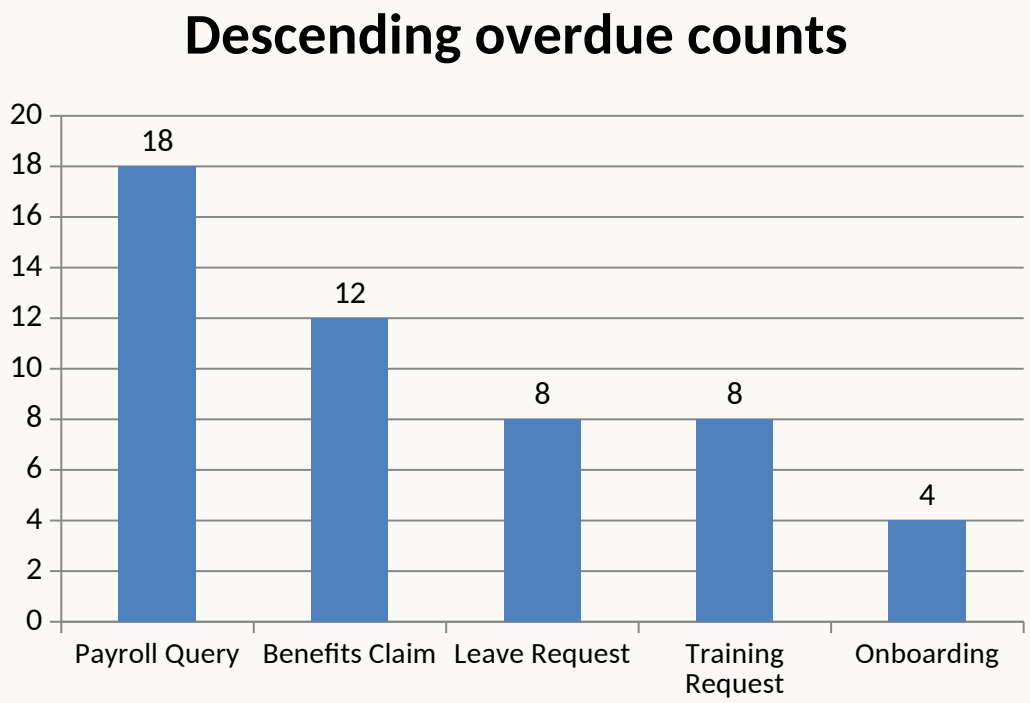
Workbook copy

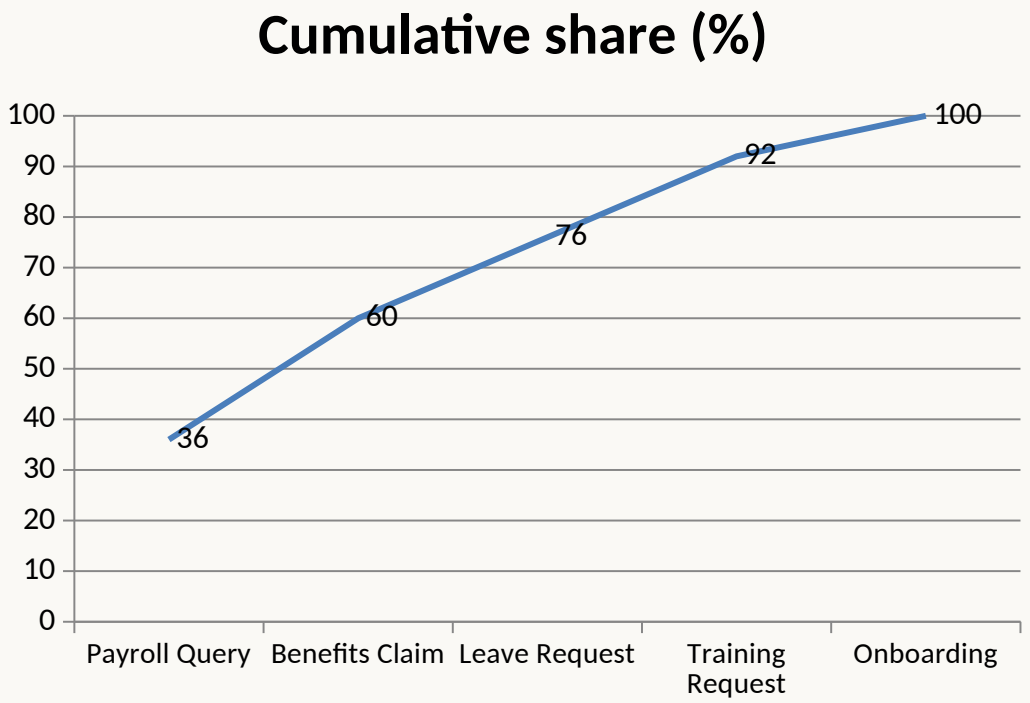
Visible .Rules travels with the copy; account preferences are not exported.

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NATIVE EDITABLE PARETO EVIDENCE

Overdue Contribution: 50 HR Cases, Five Categories





Four categories first reach 80%. Equal counts use alphabetical ties. Contribution is not cause.

Source: synthetic tblHRCases | 30 Sep 2026 | All filters All unless stated

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Pareto Skill: Counts, Sorting and Cumulative Share

WHAT IT IS

- A Pareto contribution chart cases category counts from largest to smallest and adds a cumulative-percentage line.

WHY IT MATTERS

- The Skill turns a recurring grouping-and-charting method into reusable instructions.

CHECK IT

- Payroll 18; Benefits 12; Leave 8; Training 8; Onboarding 4: total 50.

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Pareto Skill: Counts, Sorting and Cumulative Share

1. Define source, population, date and grouping.
2. Count and sort with stable ties.
3. Calculate cumulative count / eligible total.
4. Build and verify an editable dual-axis chart.

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Apply the Concept — Pareto Skill: Counts, Sorting and Cumulative Share

PROMPT PRINCIPLES

- Name the source, reporting date and selected scope.
- Explain the result using checked evidence.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- Cumulative percentages are 36%, 60%, 76%, 92%, 100%.
- Four of five categories first reach 80%; do not force an 80/20 conclusion.

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Evidence Trace — Pareto Skill: Counts, Sorting and Cumulative Share

1

Source

https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/excel/copilot/copilot-in-excel-skills

2

State

Payroll 18; Benefits 12; Leave 8; Training 8; Onboarding 4: total 50.

3

Check

Cumulative percentages are 36%, 60%, 76%, 92%, 100%.

4

Boundary

Categories are being called causes or zero-total shares treated as measured 0%.

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Create a Custom Pareto Chart Skill and Apply It

LAB 5

Author hr-case-pareto/SKILL.md with Copilot, install it in Excel and apply it to the same overdue HR-case queue. Build a descending count chart plus cumulative-percentage line, then check a controlled rerun and a second grouping.

You'll build

hr-case-pareto/SKILL.md, Lumina_Pareto.xlsx with Pareto_Request_Type and Pareto_Department, and a verified rerun record.

1 Ground	2 Build	3 Verify	4 Handoff

Tools: Excel Copilot · Microsoft 365 Copilot web · OneDrive

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Sample Prompts — Lab 5

1. Run Skill: Apply @hr-case-pareto to Lumina_HR_Cases.xlsx for overdue work at 30 September 2026; verify category counts 18, 12, 8, 8, 4 and cumulative 100%.

2. Zero case: Run the zero-overdue test and return N/A rather than dividing by zero.

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Check Your Results — Lab 5

1

Eligible population

Overdue backlog50; no Closed or Cancelled records included.

2

Category counts

Payroll Query=18; Benefits Claim=12; Leave Request=8; Training Request=8; Onboarding=4

3

Cumulative percentages

36%,60%,76%,92%,100%; Leave Request precedes Training Request in the8-count tie.

4

Chart and rerun

Editable columns plus cumulative line; right axis0%-100%; matching output replaced only after review, without duplicates.

5

Source and interpretation

120 original records preserved; Department grouping also totals50; no invented root cause.

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EDITABLE SKILL CONTRACT

Anatomy of the HR Service Skill

Discovery	name + description	When should Copilot use it?
Input guard	table or snapshot + date + scope	What evidence is missing?
Method	definitions + source preservation	How should measures be calculated?
Outputs	summary / charts / proposals	Which named areas may change?
Verification	counts + denominators + reruns	What proves the result?

Source: synthetic tblHRCases | 30 Sep 2026 | All filters All unless stated

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REPEATABLE IMPROVEMENT

A Skill Improves Through Evidence

1. v1 instructions
2. Run on verified inputs
3. Find one concrete defect
4. v2 + repeat the check

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Skills, Prompts and Workbook Rules

WHAT IT IS

- A prompt is one request.

WHY IT MATTERS

- The skill makes stable definitions and review boundaries reusable: backlog excludes two terminal statuses, overdue uses a fixed date, missing owners stay missing and output reruns do not duplicate sheets.

CHECK IT

- hr-case-reporting contains definitions and output boundaries.

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Skills, Prompts and Workbook Rules

1. Identify a recurring task.
2. Separate stable rules from current inputs.
3. Write name, description and instructions.
4. Install, invoke and inspect the result.

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Apply the Concept — Skills, Prompts and Workbook Rules

PROMPT PRINCIPLES

- Name the source, reporting date and selected scope.
- Explain the result using checked evidence.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- Each request still supplies this month’s source, date and scope.
- Native skill use and pasted manual instructions are recorded differently.

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Evidence Trace — Skills, Prompts and Workbook Rules

1

Source

https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/excel/copilot/copilot-in-excel-skills

2

State

hr-case-reporting contains definitions and output boundaries.

3

Check

Each request still supplies this month’s source, date and scope.

4

Boundary

Inputs or desired behaviour are still undefined.

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Custom Skill Discovery in Each App

WHAT IT IS

- Excel uses its Manage plugins & skills interface and an app-created OneDrive skills folder.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Folder-name/frontmatter mismatches, an extra .txt extension, unavailable licence features and disabled skills can all prevent discovery.

CHECK IT

- Folder hr-case-reporting matches YAML name hr-case-reporting.

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Custom Skill Discovery in Each App

1. Save complete UTF-8 SKILL.md.
2. Use the app-created skills location.
3. Refresh and verify the matching name.
4. Run and record a smoke test.

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Apply the Concept — Custom Skill Discovery in Each App

PROMPT PRINCIPLES

- Name the source, reporting date and selected scope.
- Explain the result using checked evidence.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- Excel and PowerPoint both show the skill before native invocation.
- If a menu is absent, manual practice is labelled feature unavailable.

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Evidence Trace — Custom Skill Discovery in Each App

1

Source

https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/excel/copilot/copilot-in-excel-skills

2

State

Folder hr-case-reporting matches YAML name hr-case-reporting.

3

Check

Excel and PowerPoint both show the skill before native invocation.

4

Boundary

A missing menu is being treated as successful installation.

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Repeatability and Safe Skill Reruns

WHAT IT IS

- Repeatability means the same verified inputs and method yield equivalent business measures and a controlled output structure.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Reporting skills may be used every week or month, so uncontrolled output accumulation quickly creates conflicting summaries.

CHECK IT

- 120 source IDs remain 120 after rerunning HR_Case_Summary.

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Repeatability and Safe Skill Reruns

1. Capture the source fingerprint and outputs.
2. Request a reviewed rerun plan.
3. Replace only named output areas.
4. Compare source and measures again.

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Apply the Concept — Repeatability and Safe Skill Reruns

PROMPT PRINCIPLES

- Name the source, reporting date and selected scope.
- Explain the result using checked evidence.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- Missing report date causes a clarification request, not invented numbers.
- A second output sheet is a defect when replacement was requested.

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Evidence Trace — Repeatability and Safe Skill Reruns

1

Source

https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/excel/copilot/copilot-in-excel-skills

2

State

120 source IDs remain 120 after rerunning HR_Case_Summary.

3

Check

Missing report date causes a clarification request, not invented numbers.

4

Boundary

The skill can overwrite source rows or unrelated sheets.

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Assignment Proposals and Capacity Evidence

WHAT IT IS

- Assignment planning combines the work category, existing owner, estimated hours, HR officer primary category and available hours.

WHY IT MATTERS

- The same skill can improve Excel analysis and PowerPoint wording by preserving this boundary.

CHECK IT

- Unassigned work is counted only within nonterminal statuses.

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Assignment Proposals and Capacity Evidence

1. Identify unassigned backlog.
2. Compare category and available hours.
3. Record the proposal and assumptions.
4. Request the manager decision.

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Apply the Concept — Assignment Proposals and Capacity Evidence

PROMPT PRINCIPLES

- Name the source, reporting date and selected scope.
- Explain the result using checked evidence.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- Available hours minus proposed effort is a planning check.
- The source Assigned_To stays unchanged until a real authorised operational update.

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Evidence Trace — Assignment Proposals and Capacity Evidence

1

Source

https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/excel/copilot/copilot-in-excel-skills

2

State

Unassigned work is counted only within nonterminal statuses.

3

Check

Available hours minus proposed effort is a planning check.

4

Boundary

The report claims automatic approval or verified policy competence.

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LAB 6 THEME · REPORTING SKILL

Create, Use and Improve the HR Service Reporting Skill

LAB 6

Reuse the Skill-authoring and installation method from Lab 5 to create hr-case-reporting. Apply it in Excel and PowerPoint, test missing inputs and a controlled rerun, then refine v2 using actual evidence.

You'll build

Lumina_Skill_Report.xlsx with HR_Case_Summary and Assignment_Proposals, Lumina_Skill_Update.pptx, SKILL.md v2 and a before/after improvement log.

1 Ground	2 Build	3 Verify	4 Handoff

Tools: Excel and PowerPoint Copilot · Microsoft 365 Copilot web · OneDrive

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Sample Prompts — Lab 6

1. Run Skill: Apply @hr-case-reporting to the verified Lumina snapshot; include total 120, backlog 60, overdue 50, source, scope and limitations.

2. Rerun: Change one filter only, rerun the Skill and reconcile the new result to the unchanged source table.

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Check Your Results — Lab 6

1

Source preserved

120 unique cases; current owner/status unchanged.

2

Skill outputs

Backlog 60; overdue 50; on-time closed 30/48; cost S$35,827.50.

3

Improvement evidence

Input guard and rerun tested; v1/v2 retained; PowerPoint four-slide output accurate.

4

LO2 checkpoint

Four transition stages have owners, evidence, success measures and rollback triggers.

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TOPIC RECAP

Recap - Skills, Rules and Personalisation

1. LO2: Personalisation, .Rules and Skills support controlled transition.

2. Verify: Source, rerun and rollback checks pass.

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TOPIC 3

Create Interactive Dashboard and Professional Presentation

Shared-scope measures, refresh tests, evidence story and reviewed handoff

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Key Concepts — Create Interactive Dashboard and Professional Presentation

1

Dashboard

Six measures and three charts share filter scope.

2

Refresh

Known deltas in a 122-row sandbox.

3

Presentation

Claims trace to the untouched baseline.

4

Teams and Outlook

Evaluate collaboration with human-send controls.

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WHAT YOU'LL DO

Hands-On Labs — Create Interactive Dashboard and Professional Presentation

Labs 7–8

- **Custom Dashboard Skill**
  - Create and Apply a Custom Interactive Dashboard Skill
- **Interactive Filters and Refresh**
  - Use the Dashboard Skill for Filters, Refresh and Safe Reruns

Labs 9–10

- **Dashboard to presentation**
  - Turn Dashboard Evidence into a Management Story
- **Professional handoff**
  - Refine and Present the HR Service Decision Deck

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WORKED DASHBOARD SNAPSHOT

Lumina Portfolio at a Glance

Total cases

120

Backlog

60

Overdue

50

Closed

48

On-time closed

30/48

Recorded cost

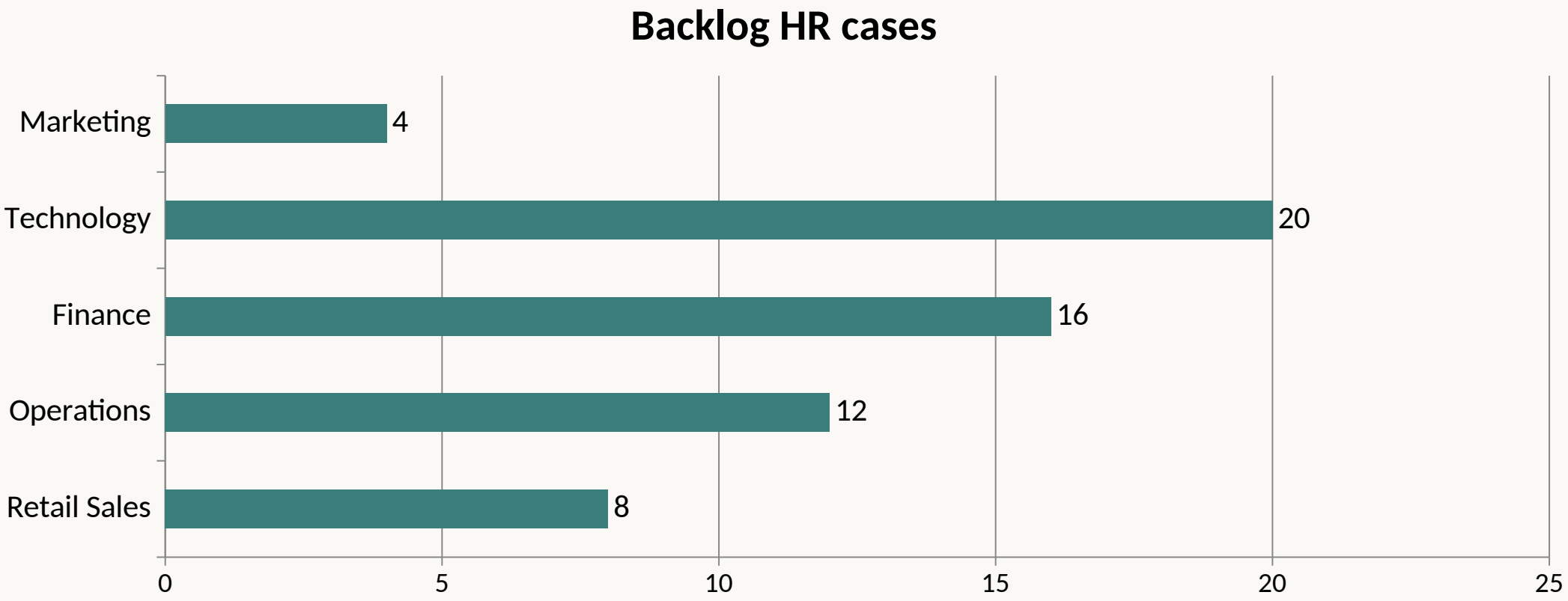
S$35,828

Source: synthetic tblHRCases | 30 Sep 2026 | All filters All unless stated

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NATIVE EDITABLE CHART

Backlog by Department: Count the Nonterminal Work



Source: synthetic tblHRCases | 30 Sep 2026 | All filters All unless stated

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The Interactive Dashboard Skill Contract

1. Named source + date
2. Six shared-scope KPIs
3. Four filters + three charts
4. Refresh + safe rerun checks

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Custom Dashboard Skill as a Reusable Contract

WHAT IT IS

- hr-case-dashboard is a separate custom Skill whose instructions define inputs, six KPI formulas, four shared filter selectors, three editable charts and controlled output boundaries.

WHY IT MATTERS

- A reusable contract makes every KPI and chart obey the same AND filter logic and allows a safe refresh using table references.

CHECK IT

- Dashboard B2:B5 select department, category, status and owner.

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Custom Dashboard Skill as a Reusable Contract

1. Author and review the complete SKILL.md.
2. Install and verify the dashboard name.
3. Invoke a plan and build the reviewed output.
4. Test common filters, append refresh and reruns.

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Apply the Concept — Custom Dashboard Skill as a Reusable Contract

PROMPT PRINCIPLES

- Name the source, reporting date and selected scope.
- Explain the result using checked evidence.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- B7:B12 and all chart summaries use the identical selected rows.
- A 122-row sandbox is separate from the untouched 120-row baseline.

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Evidence Trace — Custom Dashboard Skill as a Reusable Contract

1

Source

https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/excel/copilot/copilot-in-excel-skills

2

State

Dashboard B2:B5 select department, category, status and owner.

3

Check

B7:B12 and all chart summaries use the identical selected rows.

4

Boundary

Tenant Skill access or source preservation is being assumed.

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Dashboard Measures and Denominators

WHAT IT IS

- A dashboard measure needs a business definition, numerator, denominator where relevant, date rule and filter scope.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Changing the denominator can make an attractive rate meaningless.

CHECK IT

- Closed-only rate is different from closed/total completion share.

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Dashboard Measures and Denominators

1. Define source fields and scope.
2. Compute count and denominator.
3. Handle empty selections explicitly.
4. Reconcile against controls.

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Apply the Concept — Dashboard Measures and Denominators

PROMPT PRINCIPLES

- Name the source, reporting date and selected scope.
- Explain the result using checked evidence.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- A due-today backlog item is not overdue under a strict before-date rule.
- All selected status/chart counts reconcile to total selected HR cases.

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Evidence Trace — Dashboard Measures and Denominators

1

Source

https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/excel/create-and-share-a-dashboard-with-excel-and-microsoft-groups

2

State

Closed-only rate is different from closed/total completion share.

3

Check

A due-today backlog item is not overdue under a strict before-date rule.

4

Boundary

A zero denominator is being represented as a measured 0%.

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Visual Dashboard Design for HR Service

WHAT IT IS

- A dashboard should make an operational decision easier.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Consistent chart scales, short labels, whitespace and limited accents help a manager compare the work queue quickly.

CHECK IT

- Status count chart shows the portfolio mix.

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Visual Dashboard Design for HR Service

1. Name the HR service decision.
2. Choose the measure and comparison.
3. Use an appropriate labelled chart.
4. Check meaning and readability.

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Apply the Concept — Visual Dashboard Design for HR Service

PROMPT PRINCIPLES

- Name the source, reporting date and selected scope.
- Explain the result using checked evidence.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- Department backlog chart excludes Closed and Cancelled.
- A category count does not establish the root cause of overdue cases.

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Evidence Trace — Visual Dashboard Design for HR Service

1

Source

https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/excel/create-and-share-a-dashboard-with-excel-and-microsoft-groups

2

State

Status count chart shows the portfolio mix.

3

Check

Department backlog chart excludes Closed and Cancelled.

4

Boundary

Decorative charts hide an ambiguous metric.

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Create and Apply a Custom Interactive Dashboard Skill

LAB 7

Create hr-case-dashboard/SKILL.md for the Lumina HR service workflow, install it in Excel, then invoke it to plan and build an interactive dashboard. Six KPIs and three charts share four filter selections.

You'll build

Lumina_Dashboard.xlsx with a Dashboard layout, six verified measures, three labelled charts and a measure dictionary ready for Lab 8 filters.

1 Ground	2 Build	3 Verify	4 Handoff

Tools: Excel Copilot · Microsoft 365 Copilot web · OneDrive

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Sample Prompts — Lab 7

1. Build: Apply @hr-case-dashboard to Lumina_HR_Cases.xlsx using six KPIs, Department/Category/Status/Owner filters and three editable chart summaries.

2. Verify: At All filters confirm total 120, backlog 60, overdue 50, closed 48, on-time rate 62.5% and recorded cost SGD 35,827.50.

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Check Your Results — Lab 7

1

Baseline

Total 120; backlog 60; overdue 50; closed 48.

2

SLA and cost

30/48 = 62.5%; S$35,827.50.

3

Chart reconciliation

Three count summaries each total 120; formulas reference tblHRCases.

4

Decision design

Measures dictionary and source/date visible; no unsupported cause claims.

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EDITABLE WORKED COMPARISON

Same Data, Different Filter Scope

All departments

Total: 120

Backlog: 60

Overdue: 50

Closed: 48

On-time closed: 30/48

Retail Sales

Total: 24

Backlog: 8

Overdue: 7

Closed: 16

On-time closed: 10/16

Source: synthetic tblHRCases | 30 Sep 2026 | All filters All unless stated

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One Filter Scope for Every Visual

WHAT IT IS

- Interactive means a learner-controlled selection changes the evidence shown.

WHY IT MATTERS

- A dashboard can appear interactive while only one chart changes.

CHECK IT

- Retail Sales plus All in other selectors isolates that department.

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One Filter Scope for Every Visual

1. Define the selector cells.
2. Apply the same AND mask everywhere.
3. Test each control and edge case.
4. Reconcile selected chart and KPI totals.

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Apply the Concept — One Filter Scope for Every Visual

PROMPT PRINCIPLES

- Name the source, reporting date and selected scope.
- Explain the result using checked evidence.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- Status New gives zero Closed and N/A closure rate.
- A slicer must connect to every intended PivotTable.

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Evidence Trace — One Filter Scope for Every Visual

1

Source

https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/excel/get-started/use-slicers-to-filter-data

2

State

Retail Sales plus All in other selectors isolates that department.

3

Check

Status New gives zero Closed and N/A closure rate.

4

Boundary

A selector only changes a decorative title or one chart.

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Refresh Tests and Static Snapshots

WHAT IT IS

- A refresh test deliberately introduces known new records and verifies the expected delta.

WHY IT MATTERS

- A correct dashboard today may fail after the next export if formulas reference a fixed cell range.

CHECK IT

- Two test rows increase total by 2 and recorded cost by S$400.

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Refresh Tests and Static Snapshots

1. Save an isolated sandbox copy.
2. Append known unique test rows.
3. Recalculate and verify expected deltas.
4. Handoff the untouched baseline.

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Apply the Concept — Refresh Tests and Static Snapshots

PROMPT PRINCIPLES

- Name the source, reporting date and selected scope.
- Explain the result using checked evidence.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- Only one new row adds to backlog/overdue; the other adds to on-time Closed.
- The final deck uses the untouched 120-row baseline, not the test copy.

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Evidence Trace — Refresh Tests and Static Snapshots

1

Source

https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/excel/create-and-share-a-dashboard-with-excel-and-microsoft-groups

2

State

Two test rows increase total by 2 and recorded cost by S$400.

3

Check

Only one new row adds to backlog/overdue; the other adds to on-time Closed.

4

Boundary

Test rows are being mixed into the report without disclosure.

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Use the Dashboard Skill for Filters, Refresh and Safe Reruns

LAB 8

Continue Lab 7 by making four dropdown selectors control every KPI and chart. Test a single department, a zero-denominator selection and a combined category/owner filter.

You'll build

Lumina_Dashboard.xlsx with four working filters plus Lumina_Dashboard_Refresh_Test.xlsx, filter evidence and a verified baseline snapshot for PowerPoint.

1 Ground	2 Build	3 Verify	4 Handoff

Tools: Excel Copilot · Microsoft 365 Copilot web · OneDrive

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Sample Prompts — Lab 8

1. Refresh: Append Refresh_Test_Rows.csv in the sandbox, refresh @hr-case-dashboard and verify total 122, backlog 61, overdue 51 and closed 49.

2. Empty scope: Filter Retail Sales, Leave Request and Daniel Lee; show an explicit empty state rather than a zero-data chart.

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Check Your Results — Lab 8

1

Retail Sales control

Total 24; backlog 8; overdue 7; closed 16; cost S$6,668.50; on-time 10/16.

2

Interactive scope

Changing any of four filters affects all six KPI measures and all chart counts.

3

Edge case

No Closed -> N/A; no rows -> zero count/cost and N/A rate.

4

Refresh sandbox

122 total;49 closed;61 backlog;51 overdue;S$36,227.50;31/49 on-time.

5

Handoff baseline

Return to 120-row untouched baseline; date and All scope recorded.

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EVIDENCE TO NARRATIVE

A Verified Chart Becomes a Decision

1. Observed backlog
2. Operational implication
3. Proposed recovery action
4. Manager decision requested

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From Dashboard Evidence to a Decision Story

WHAT IT IS

- A management presentation transforms evidence into a sequence of observations, implications, proposed actions and a decision request.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Copilot can accelerate outlines and drafting, but a persuasive invented conclusion is still wrong.

CHECK IT

- Backlog by department supports prioritisation, not a proven cause.

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From Dashboard Evidence to a Decision Story

1. Freeze the verified dashboard snapshot.
2. Register each proposed claim.
3. Write a reviewed Word brief.
4. Generate and reconcile the deck.

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Apply the Concept — From Dashboard Evidence to a Decision Story

PROMPT PRINCIPLES

- Name the source, reporting date and selected scope.
- Explain the result using checked evidence.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- Available-hours evidence supports a capacity discussion, not confirmed allocation.
- The final slide asks management to decide on a proposed plan.

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Evidence Trace — From Dashboard Evidence to a Decision Story

1

Source

https://support.microsoft.com/en-gb/word/copilot/draft-and-add-content-with-copilot-in-word

2

State

Backlog by department supports prioritisation, not a proven cause.

3

Check

Available-hours evidence supports a capacity discussion, not confirmed allocation.

4

Boundary

The story introduces savings, causes or approvals absent from evidence.

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Charts, Templates and Source Provenance

WHAT IT IS

- A template supplies slide layouts, typography and colours; it does not supply correct facts.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Approximate AI-generated charts can contradict source values while looking plausible.

CHECK IT

- An editable embedded chart remains a copy rather than a tested live link.

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Charts, Templates and Source Provenance

1. Select the reviewed brief.
2. Apply the existing template.
3. Insert verified charts or tables.
4. Record source and snapshot scope.

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Apply the Concept — Charts, Templates and Source Provenance

PROMPT PRINCIPLES

- Name the source, reporting date and selected scope.
- Explain the result using checked evidence.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- An image is labelled as a snapshot at 30 September.
- All eight slides use one reviewed baseline.

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Evidence Trace — Charts, Templates and Source Provenance

1

Source

https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/powerpoint/copilot/add-a-slide-from-a-file-with-copilot-in-powerpoint

2

State

An editable embedded chart remains a copy rather than a tested live link.

3

Check

An image is labelled as a snapshot at 30 September.

4

Boundary

A visual is assumed accurate because Copilot produced it.

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Turn Dashboard Evidence into a Management Story

LAB 9

Continue the baseline dashboard from Topic 3. Build a slide evidence register and a Word presentation brief before asking PowerPoint Copilot for an eight-slide management deck.

You'll build

Lumina_Presentation_Brief.docx, Lumina_HR_Management_Draft.pptx and a slide-by-slide evidence register tied to the 120-row dashboard snapshot.

1 Ground	2 Build	3 Verify	4 Handoff

Tools: Microsoft 365 Copilot · Excel · Word · PowerPoint · Outlook · OneDrive

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Sample Prompts — Lab 9

1. Story: Using the verified dashboard snapshot, outline an eight-slide Lumina management story with claim, value, source, scope, as-at date and limitation for each slide.

2. Outlook: Draft an unsent Outlook review request that names the deck version and asks the HR manager to confirm proposed assignments.

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Check Your Results — Lab 9

1

Evidence continuity

Every deck figure maps to the 120-row Lab 8 baseline and slide evidence register.

2

Eight-slide narrative

Observation -> implication -> proposed action -> decision; no invented cause/savings.

3

Chart semantics

Backlog charts exclude Closed/Cancelled; embedded/image copies labelled snapshot.

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ARTIFACT LIFECYCLE

The HR Service Reporting Handoff

1

Interactive workbook

2

Dated Word evidence

3

Static PPTX + PDF

4

Reviewed unsent email

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Professional Refinement and Rehearsal

WHAT IT IS

- Refinement improves the clarity of the existing evidence without changing its meaning.

WHY IT MATTERS

- A well-designed deck can still fail when the speaker's notes contain different numbers or a proposal is spoken as an approved action.

CHECK IT

- One message per slide; chart labels remain readable.

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Professional Refinement and Rehearsal

1. Audit the draft against evidence.
2. Apply reviewed design changes.
3. Rehearse and record actual feedback.
4. Inspect PPTX and exported PDF.

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Apply the Concept — Professional Refinement and Rehearsal

PROMPT PRINCIPLES

- Name the source, reporting date and selected scope.
- Explain the result using checked evidence.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- A 45-second note explains evidence and limitation.
- Partner feedback leads to one recorded revision.

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Evidence Trace — Professional Refinement and Rehearsal

1

Source

https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/powerpoint/copilot/copilot-in-powerpoint-skills

2

State

One message per slide; chart labels remain readable.

3

Check

A 45-second note explains evidence and limitation.

4

Boundary

Polish hides an unsupported claim or unreadable chart.

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Reviewed Handoff and Artifact Lifecycle

WHAT IT IS

- The final pack contains an interactive Excel dashboard, a fixed reporting brief, a static PowerPoint/PDF snapshot, the custom skill and a reviewed communication draft.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Updating one artifact without the others creates inconsistent communication.

CHECK IT

- PowerPoint and PDF both show eight slides/pages from the same baseline.

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Reviewed Handoff and Artifact Lifecycle

1. Reconcile final artifacts.
2. Record actual filenames and links.
3. Review the handoff draft.
4. Preserve the dated snapshot and skill.

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Apply the Concept — Reviewed Handoff and Artifact Lifecycle

PROMPT PRINCIPLES

- Name the source, reporting date and selected scope.
- Explain the result using checked evidence.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- Outlook does not claim a missing attachment was sent.
- The next update reruns the method with new verified inputs.

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Evidence Trace — Reviewed Handoff and Artifact Lifecycle

1

Source

https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/file-formats-supported-by-microsoft-365-copilot

2

State

PowerPoint and PDF both show eight slides/pages from the same baseline.

3

Check

Outlook does not claim a missing attachment was sent.

4

Boundary

A refreshed dashboard is assumed to rewrite an old presentation.

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Refine and Present the HR Service Decision Deck

LAB 10

Refine the management deck using the same custom skill and reviewed dashboard evidence. Improve hierarchy, consistency and speaker notes, test the story in a short rehearsal, and prepare a reviewed Outlook handoff draft.

You'll build

Lumina_HR_Management_Final.pptx/PDF, a rehearsal record, final evidence register and unsent Outlook handoff draft with accurate artifact links.

1 Ground	2 Build	3 Verify	4 Handoff

Tools: Microsoft 365 Copilot · Excel · Word · PowerPoint · Outlook · OneDrive

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Sample Prompts — Lab 10

1. Refine: Refine Lumina_HR_Decision_Deck.pptx for readable titles, editable charts, source notes and a clear current-versus-proposed assignment boundary.

2. Rehearse: Use Rehearsal_Log.csv to record feedback, evidence, change and retest before the final handoff.

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Check Your Results — Lab 10

1

Presentation integrity

Eight slides and eight PDF pages; visible figures agree with verified register.

2

Professional delivery

Readable chart labels, consistent design, evidence-specific notes and actual rehearsal improvement.

3

Final continuity

Baseline dashboard, brief, deck and unsent draft agree; static snapshot stated.

4

Decision boundary

No real email sent or HR case reassigned; proposed actions remain proposed.

5

LO3 checkpoint

Outlook and Teams rows use supplied evidence, observable value, readiness, risk/control and a human gate.

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TOPIC RECAP

Recap - Create Interactive Dashboard and Professional Presentation

1. LO3: Dashboard and presentation support Teams/Outlook opportunity evaluation.

2. Verify: Claims use untouched fixed-date baseline.

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TOPIC 4

Create Microsoft 365 Agents for Businesses

Build a grounded HR agent: scope, knowledge, Skill, tests, sharing and staff enablement

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Key Concepts — Create Microsoft 365 Agents for Businesses

1

Boundary

HR helpdesk answers; no approvals, sends or record changes.

2

Knowledge

Permission-aware HR handbook and verified case snapshot.

3

Skill

hr-policy-qa sets format, citations and privacy rules.

4

Evaluation

Known-answer, privacy and guardrail tests before named-user sharing.

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WHAT YOU'LL DO

Hands-On Labs — Create Microsoft 365 Agents for Businesses

Labs 11–12

- **Agent Scope and Knowledge**
  - Design the HR Policy Agent: Users, Knowledge and Skill
- **Agent Configuration**
  - Build the HR Agent: Instructions, Knowledge, Skill and Starter Prompts

Labs 13–14

- **Agent Test and Evaluation**
  - Test Grounded HR Answers, Citations and Guardrails
- **Governed Sharing and Enablement**
  - Share the HR Agent with Named Users and Deliver Staff Enablement

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An HR Agent Answers from Approved Knowledge

WHAT IT IS

- Agent Builder creates declarative agents for focused retrieval and drafting in Microsoft 365 Copilot.

WHY IT MATTERS

- A precise boundary keeps a helpful HR assistant from being mistaken for an approval system or a source of other people's data.

CHECK IT

- Annual leave answer cites section 1

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An HR Agent Answers from Approved Knowledge

1. Name users and questions
2. List approved knowledge
3. State refused requests
4. Define success and escalation

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Apply the Agent Control — An HR Agent Answers from Approved Knowledge

CONFIGURATION PRINCIPLE

- Name the intended user, permitted knowledge and response boundary.
- State the test evidence that proves this behaviour.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- No approvals, sends or record changes
- HR Business Partner handles UNKNOWN

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Evidence Trace — An HR Agent Answers from Approved Knowledge

1

Source

https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/extensibility/agent-builder

2

State

Annual leave answer cites section 1

3

Check

No approvals, sends or record changes

4

Boundary

The task needs approvals, live HR records or another employee's data.

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Knowledge Inventory and Permission Model

WHAT IT IS

- Knowledge can include SharePoint, OneDrive, embedded files and other licensed sources.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Owner success can hide user-access failure.

CHECK IT

- Existing permissions stay in force

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Knowledge Inventory and Permission Model

1. Inventory sources
2. Record owner and date
3. Check user permission
4. Test as a representative user

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Apply the Agent Control — Knowledge Inventory and Permission Model

CONFIGURATION PRINCIPLE

- Name the intended user, permitted knowledge and response boundary.
- State the test evidence that proves this behaviour.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- Restricted case notes are excluded
- A local path is not cloud knowledge

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Evidence Trace — Knowledge Inventory and Permission Model

1

Source

https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/extensibility/copilot-studio-lite-knowledge

2

State

Existing permissions stay in force

3

Check

Restricted case notes are excluded

4

Boundary

Ownership or intended-user access is unknown.

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Skills Shape Every Agent Answer

WHAT IT IS

- A Skill is a reusable SKILL.md instruction package.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Without a consistent method, two correct sources can still produce uncited, over-confident or privacy-breaking answers.

CHECK IT

- Answer, conditions, next step, Sources

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Skills Shape Every Agent Answer

1. Write the Skill rules
2. Check them against the handbook
3. Compress the folder to .zip
4. Upload and verify it is enabled

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Apply the Agent Control — Skills Shape Every Agent Answer

CONFIGURATION PRINCIPLE

- Name the intended user, permitted knowledge and response boundary.
- State the test evidence that proves this behaviour.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- UNKNOWN plus HR Business Partner referral
- Never reveal another employee’s data

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Evidence Trace — Skills Shape Every Agent Answer

1

Source

https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/extensibility/agent-builder-build-agents

2

State

Answer, conditions, next step, Sources

3

Check

UNKNOWN plus HR Business Partner referral

4

Boundary

The Skill is used to smuggle in facts that belong in knowledge.

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Design the HR Policy Agent: Users, Knowledge and Skill

LAB 11

Design Lumina HR Policy Agent, an HR helpdesk agent that answers employees' HR questions from approved knowledge. Decide who it serves and which questions it must answer, inventory and check the HR Policy Handbook and case snapshot it will use, review the hr-policy-qa Skill that shapes every answer, and draft the agent in Agent Builder.

You'll build

A reviewed design brief, a completed knowledge inventory with owners and access, the four knowledge files in OneDrive, hr-policy-qa.zip and a private agent draft (or a labelled configuration-only record).

1 Describe	2 Configure	3 Ground	4 Test

Tools: Microsoft 365 Copilot (copilot.cloud.microsoft) · Agent Builder · OneDrive · Microsoft Loop

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Sample Prompts — Lab 11

1. Scope: Using Lumina_HR_Agent_Design_Brief.md, define a private HR helpdesk agent that cites the HR Policy Handbook and never approves, sends or reveals another employee's data.

2. Inventory: Record owner, as-at date, type and user access for the handbook, snapshot, workbook and enablement plan; exclude the restricted case notes.

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Check Your Results — Lab 11

1

Scope

One HR helpdesk outcome: cited policy answers and case figures; no approvals, sends or record changes.

2

Knowledge

Four files with owner, date, type and verified user access; restricted notes excluded.

3

Skill

hr-policy-qa reviewed against the handbook and compressed to hr-policy-qa.zip.

4

State

Private draft or accurately labelled configuration-only route.

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Instruction Contract and Response Format

WHAT IT IS

- Instructions define role, sources, answer style and boundaries; Agent Builder documents an 8,000-character limit.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Specific instructions create observable pass rules for citations, UNKNOWN, conflicts, privacy and refused actions.

CHECK IT

- Answer plus Sources

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Instruction Contract and Response Format

1. Define role
2. Name sources
3. Define UNKNOWN and conflicts
4. Name refused requests

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Apply the Agent Control — Instruction Contract and Response Format

CONFIGURATION PRINCIPLE

- Name the intended user, permitted knowledge and response boundary.
- State the test evidence that proves this behaviour.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- Conflict answered from approved version
- Approval requests routed to the HR portal

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Evidence Trace — Instruction Contract and Response Format

1

Source

https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/extensibility/agent-builder-build-agents

2

State

Answer plus Sources

3

Check

Conflict answered from approved version

4

Boundary

Instructions are treated as a security control.

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Grounding: Only Use Specified Sources

WHAT IT IS

- The Configure tab adds knowledge and optional web search.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Citations and known-answer tests give stronger evidence than a web-search toggle alone.

CHECK IT

- Leave entitlement cited to section 1

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Grounding: Only Use Specified Sources

1. Add approved sources
2. Record web state
3. Require citations
4. Test supported and unsupported questions

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Apply the Agent Control — Grounding: Only Use Specified Sources

CONFIGURATION PRINCIPLE

- Name the intended user, permitted knowledge and response boundary.
- State the test evidence that proves this behaviour.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- Sabbatical returns UNKNOWN
- No uncited policy claim

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Evidence Trace — Grounding: Only Use Specified Sources

1

Source

https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/extensibility/copilot-studio-lite-knowledge

2

State

Leave entitlement cited to section 1

3

Check

Sabbatical returns UNKNOWN

4

Boundary

An uncited answer passes because web search is off.

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Starter Prompts as Discoverable Test Cases

WHAT IT IS

- Starter prompts show employees which questions the agent is designed to answer; they do not expand permissions or capability.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Prompts mapped to handbook sections and tests teach correct use and support onboarding.

CHECK IT

- Annual leave

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Starter Prompts as Discoverable Test Cases

1. Map prompt to section
2. State expected evidence
3. Run in Try it
4. Keep passing cases

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Apply the Agent Control — Starter Prompts as Discoverable Test Cases

CONFIGURATION PRINCIPLE

- Name the intended user, permitted knowledge and response boundary.
- State the test evidence that proves this behaviour.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- GP claim limit
- Training request route

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Evidence Trace — Starter Prompts as Discoverable Test Cases

1

Source

https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/extensibility/agent-builder-build-agents

2

State

Annual leave

3

Check

GP claim limit

4

Boundary

A prompt implies approval or live data.

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Build the HR Agent: Instructions, Knowledge, Skill and Starter Prompts

LAB 12

Configure Lumina HR Policy Agent with reviewed instructions, the four OneDrive knowledge files and the hr-policy-qa Skill, add starter prompts, then preview a grounded answer and a missing-evidence answer before you create it. Grounding comes from the knowledge; the Skill sets how every answer is structured, cited and bounded.

You'll build

A private configured HR agent (or an evidence-complete configuration record) whose preview answers are cited and whose missing-evidence answer is UNKNOWN.

1 Describe	2 Configure	3 Ground	4 Test

Tools: Microsoft 365 Copilot (copilot.cloud.microsoft) · Agent Builder · OneDrive · Microsoft Loop

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Sample Prompts — Lab 12

1. Configure: Configure Lumina HR Policy Agent with the reviewed instructions, four OneDrive knowledge files, the hr-policy-qa Skill and four starter prompts; keep it private.

2. Preview: Ask the year-3 annual leave question (expect 18 days, cited) and the sabbatical question (expect UNKNOWN).

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Check Your Results — Lab 12

1

Instructions

Role, sources, citation, UNKNOWN, privacy and approval boundaries explicit.

2

Knowledge

Four OneDrive files match the inventory; Only use specified sources recorded.

3

Skill

hr-policy-qa enabled, or the manual route labelled.

4

Preview

18 days cited to section 1; sabbatical returns UNKNOWN before Create.

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HR Test Matrix and Known Answers

WHAT IT IS

- A test matrix fixes prompt, configuration version, expected evidence and pass rule across retrieval and boundary cases.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Known answers such as 18 days of year-3 leave make grounding deterministic; boundary cases reveal unsafe answers before employees see them.

CHECK IT

- T01 returns 18 days

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HR Test Matrix and Known Answers

1. Freeze configuration
2. Run exact prompt
3. Record answer and citation
4. Repair or block

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Apply the Agent Control — HR Test Matrix and Known Answers

CONFIGURATION PRINCIPLE

- Name the intended user, permitted knowledge and response boundary.
- State the test evidence that proves this behaviour.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- T05 approves nothing
- T08 answers from the approved version

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Evidence Trace — HR Test Matrix and Known Answers

1

Source

https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/extensibility/declarative-agent-best-practices

2

State

T01 returns 18 days

3

Check

T05 approves nothing

4

Boundary

Polish substitutes for evidence.

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Citation and Conflict Tests

WHAT IT IS

- Grounded answers identify the handbook section or snapshot for entitlements, amounts, deadlines and case figures; conflicting sources trigger a flag, not a merged answer.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Citations reveal source drift and outdated pages before they reach employees.

CHECK IT

- S$40 per GP visit cited to section 4

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Citation and Conflict Tests

1. Ask a known answer
2. Open the citation
3. Compare section and version
4. Inject a conflict

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Apply the Agent Control — Citation and Conflict Tests

CONFIGURATION PRINCIPLE

- Name the intended user, permitted knowledge and response boundary.
- State the test evidence that proves this behaviour.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- Overdue cases cited to the snapshot
- Old intranet page flagged

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Evidence Trace — Citation and Conflict Tests

1

Source

https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/extensibility/declarative-agent-best-practices

2

State

S$40 per GP visit cited to section 4

3

Check

Overdue cases cited to the snapshot

4

Boundary

The agent averages or merges conflicting values.

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Privacy, Live-Data and Approval Tests

WHAT IT IS

- Test as an intended user for another employee's data, restricted files, live balances and approve/send requests.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Owner access conceals permission defects; a policy handbook cannot answer live balances; Agent Builder does not perform external actions.

CHECK IT

- No salary or medical disclosure

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Privacy, Live-Data and Approval Tests

1. Use a named tester
2. Run the privacy case
3. Run the live-data case
4. Request a prohibited action

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Apply the Agent Control — Privacy, Live-Data and Approval Tests

CONFIGURATION PRINCIPLE

- Name the intended user, permitted knowledge and response boundary.
- State the test evidence that proves this behaviour.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- Leave balance UNKNOWN, see HR portal
- No approval or email claimed

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Evidence Trace — Privacy, Live-Data and Approval Tests

1

Source

https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/extensibility/agent-builder

2

State

No salary or medical disclosure

3

Check

Leave balance UNKNOWN, see HR portal

4

Boundary

Testing needs broad permissions or simulated success.

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Test Grounded HR Answers, Citations and Guardrails

LAB 13

Run the eight-case evaluation against instruction version v1.0. Policy and case-figure questions must return the known answer with a cited section; unknown, live-data, privacy, conflict and approval requests must be handled safely.

You'll build

A completed eight-case test matrix with actual answers, citations and pass/fail, one corrected defect with a clean retest, and a sharing decision.

1 Describe	2 Configure	3 Ground	4 Test

Tools: Microsoft 365 Copilot (copilot.cloud.microsoft) · Agent Builder · OneDrive · Microsoft Loop

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Sample Prompts — Lab 13

1. Evaluate: Run T01 through T08 against instruction v1.0; record actual answer, citation, pass/fail, defect and retest.

2. Guardrail: Verify T01 returns 18 days cited, T03 returns 50 overdue, T05 approves nothing and T06 discloses nothing.

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Check Your Results — Lab 13

1

Coverage

All eight tests have actual answers, citations and results.

2

Grounding

T01 18 days; T02 S$40/S$500/30 days; T03 50 overdue - each cited.

3

Boundaries

T05 approves and sends nothing; T06 discloses nothing; T07 balance UNKNOWN.

4

Repair

One weakness corrected and retested, or a no-defect result critically documented.

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Sharing Roles and Knowledge Access

WHAT IT IS

- Agent sharing supports user (Can chat) and owner (Can edit) roles, but access to the agent does not guarantee retrieval from every SharePoint or OneDrive source.

WHY IT MATTERS

- A link that opens without grounded retrieval is not a successful rollout.

CHECK IT

- Named tester: chat and open citations

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Sharing Roles and Knowledge Access

1. Pass blocking tests
2. Choose named roles
3. Verify sources
4. Acquire and retest

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Apply the Agent Control — Sharing Roles and Knowledge Access

CONFIGURATION PRINCIPLE

- Name the intended user, permitted knowledge and response boundary.
- State the test evidence that proves this behaviour.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- Named owner: update, share and manage
- T06 privacy result blocks release

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Evidence Trace — Sharing Roles and Knowledge Access

1

Source

https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/extensibility/agent-builder-share-manage-agents

2

State

Named tester: chat and open citations

3

Check

Named owner: update, share and manage

4

Boundary

Organisation-wide sharing bypasses missing source access.

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Agent Lifecycle Ownership and Rollback

WHAT IT IS

- A shared agent needs owners, instruction and Skill versions, a test log, a review trigger and a rollback record.

WHY IT MATTERS

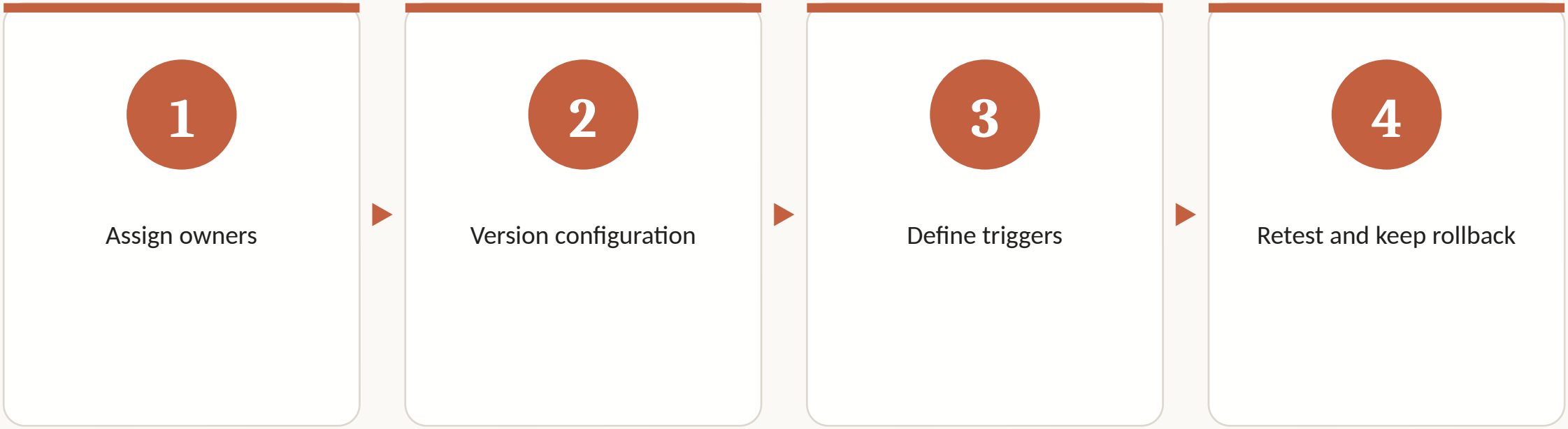
- The handbook, permissions, product behaviour and tenant policy change; retesting protects current use.

CHECK IT

- Instruction v1.0 plus handbook version 2026.3

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Agent Lifecycle Ownership and Rollback



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Apply the Agent Control — Agent Lifecycle Ownership and Rollback

CONFIGURATION PRINCIPLE

- Name the intended user, permitted knowledge and response boundary.
- State the test evidence that proves this behaviour.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- Retest T01, T05 and T06 monthly or after change
- Keep previous passing configuration and defect log

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Evidence Trace — Agent Lifecycle Ownership and Rollback

1

Source

https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/extensibility/agent-builder-share-manage-agents

2

State

Instruction v1.0 plus handbook version 2026.3

3

Check

Retest T01, T05 and T06 monthly or after change

4

Boundary

A shared link is treated as the end of the lifecycle.

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Microsoft Loop Staff Enablement Evidence

WHAT IT IS

- A Loop component can record roster, practice, evidence, defect, owner, retest and status; it does not prove agent action or approval.

WHY IT MATTERS

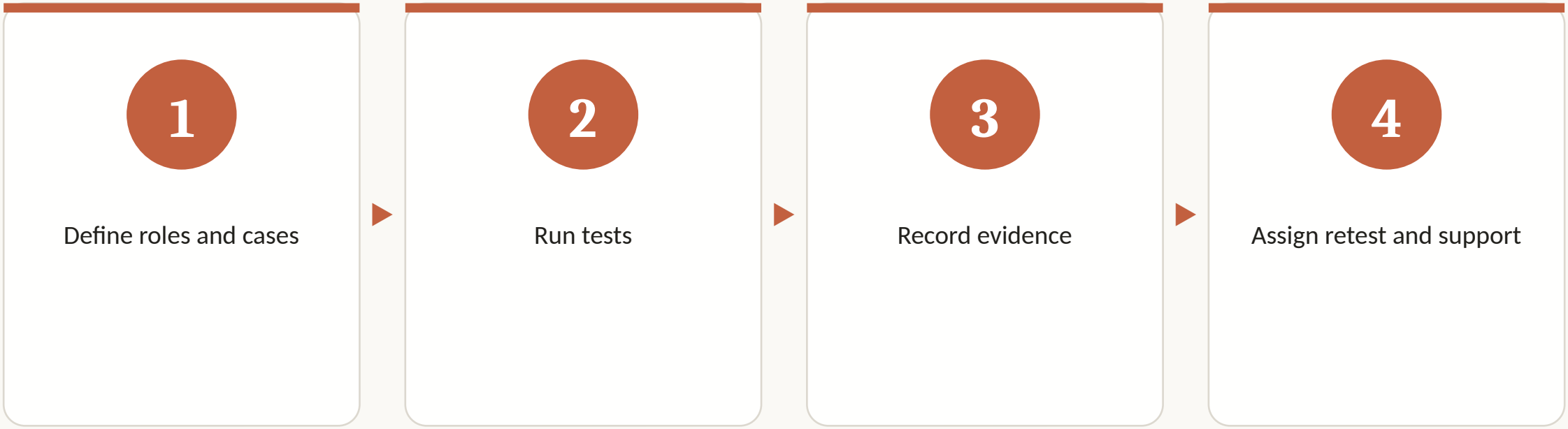
- LO4 requires a staff training plan with observed evidence and support ownership.

CHECK IT

- Loop columns: User, Role, Practice test, Evidence

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Microsoft Loop Staff Enablement Evidence



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Apply the Agent Control — Microsoft Loop Staff Enablement Evidence

CONFIGURATION PRINCIPLE

- Name the intended user, permitted knowledge and response boundary.
- State the test evidence that proves this behaviour.

EVIDENCE TO CHECK

- Defect, Owner, Retest and Status stay observable
- Practice includes cited leave answer, UNKNOWN and refusal

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Evidence Trace — Microsoft Loop Staff Enablement Evidence

1

Source

https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/extensibility/declarative-agent-best-practices

2

State

Loop columns: User, Role, Practice test, Evidence

3

Check

Defect, Owner, Retest and Status stay observable

4

Boundary

A prefilled checklist is presented as completion.

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Share the HR Agent with Named Users and Deliver Staff Enablement

LAB 14

Share Lumina HR Policy Agent only after the blocking tests pass. Verify that named users already have access to every knowledge file, retest as a user, then use Microsoft Loop to track staff practice, defects and retests as part of the LO4 staff training plan.

You'll build

A named-user sharing record, a test-user result, a Microsoft Loop enablement tracker and a rollback-ready owner plan.

1 Describe	2 Configure	3 Ground	4 Test

Tools: Microsoft 365 Copilot (copilot.cloud.microsoft) · Agent Builder · OneDrive · Microsoft Loop

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Sample Prompts — Lab 14

1. Share: After T01-T08 pass, share Lumina HR Policy Agent with one named test user (Can chat) who already has access to the knowledge files.

2. Enable: Create a Microsoft Loop tracker with User, Role, Practice test, Evidence, Defect, Owner, Retest and Status; do not prefill completion.

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Check Your Results — Lab 14

1

Gate

All blocking retrieval, privacy and approval tests pass before sharing.

2

Sharing

Named users only, with Can chat; knowledge access verified.

3

Loop plan

Actual practice evidence, defect owner and retest visible.

4

Lifecycle

Owners, review trigger and rollback assigned.

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TOPIC RECAP

Recap - Create Microsoft 365 Agents for Businesses

1. LO4: Staff training covers Agent Builder, Loop practice, owners and support.

2. Verify: Eight tests and named-user access pass before sharing.

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WRAP-UP

Course Summary & Next Steps

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What You Achieved

1

Integration risks

Predict and mitigate challenges in integrating Microsoft Copilot to workflow.

2

Transition plan

Develop a plan for implementing Microsoft Copilot to ensure seamless transition from legacy workflow.

3

Teams and Outlook opportunities

Evaluate opportunities in using Microsoft Copilot for Teams and Outlook.

4

Staff training plan

Design a training plan for staff to use Microsoft Loop and Copilot Studio.

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NEXT STEPS

Your Next Governed HR Copilot Workflow

1. Use a new verified date and keep the prior snapshot.
2. Retest Skills and the HR agent after any handbook, permission, model or policy change.
3. Keep sends, approvals, HR decisions and case assignments under visible human control.

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Keep Practising After the Course

1. Re-run the labs on your own machine — repetition is what makes the skills stick.
2. Apply the techniques to a real process or project in your own organisation.
3. Keep your downloaded TGS-2024043856 course files and use the lab checkpoints to restart safely.
4. Explore the follow-on courses at www.tertiarycourses.com.sg.

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5 Principles of AI Security

1

1 · Data control

Share only the data a task needs. Use synthetic or sanitised HR data; never paste personal data into an unapproved tool.

2

2 · Permission control

Least privilege for files, Skills and agents. Users get Can chat, the agent gets only approved knowledge, and access is never widened to pass a test.

3

3 · Human in the loop

Plan, review and approve before an edit, email, approval or HR decision takes effect. Copilot drafts; a person decides.

4

4 · Traceability

Log prompts, sources, versions and checks. Every HR answer cites its handbook section; every figure traces to the verified snapshot.

5

5 · Don’t use the most powerful model

Choose an approved, well-tested model that fits the task. The newest or most powerful model is not automatically the safest or most predictable.

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ASSESSMENT

WA-SAQ & Practical Performance

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BEFORE ASSESSMENT

Briefing for Assessment

1. Work individually; do not discuss or share answers during either paper.
2. Open book: use the slides, Learner Guide and approved course materials.
3. WA-SAQ is 60 minutes; PP is 60 minutes.
4. For PP, use the blank workbook issued before timing and submit exactly one screenshot per task.
5. Do not photograph or record assessment scripts; do not include credentials or personal data.
6. Re-assessment and appeal arrangements apply to a Not Yet Competent outcome.

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Assessment

1

Written Assessment

Four short-answer questions · K1, K3, K2, K4 · 60 minutes · open book.

2

Practical Performance

Four atomic tasks · A1–A4 · exactly one screenshot per task · 60 minutes · open book.

3

Outcome

Competent (C) or Not Yet Competent (NYC) for every question/task.

4

Eligibility

Minimum 75% attendance and a Competent assessment outcome.

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ASSESSMENT DAY

Assessment Flow

1. Complete TRAQOM survey
2. Assessment digital attendance
3. Sit WA-SAQ then PP
4. Submit on LMS
5. Sign Assessment Summary Record

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Digital Attendance (Mandatory)

1

Training attendance

Confirm both days' AM and PM records are complete.

2

Assessment attendance

Complete the separate assessment attendance before starting.

3

TRAQOM

Complete the SSG Training Quality and Outcome Measurement survey when instructed.

4

Final check

Maintain at least 75% attendance and submit both assessment methods.

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THANK YOU FOR ATTENDING

Thank You!

Keep your HR evidence connected, your agent grounded and the 5 Principles of AI Security in every workflow.

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